

Venture Capital & Corporate Venturing

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Over the last half a century, venture capital (VC) has been an important force in matching innovative business ideas to entrepreneurial resources. Nowadays, the VC landscape consists of different types of investors, including private VCs, corporate VC investors as well as the governmental VCs. They jointly foster an ecosystem in which startup companies can thrive. For example, household name technology-based companies like Facebook and Google received VC funding in their early days and became important players in the global economy. Nowadays, Google's VC arm (Google Ventures) invests in many new startup companies to help them grow, while at the same time trying to learn from them.

Academic research on VC has flourished during the last two decades with hundreds of published articles in entrepreneurship, finance, and management fields. In addition to the importance of VC as a focus of research as such, what makes VC research particularly important and timely for broader audience of management scholars is the increasing use of VC as a context to develop and test broader management theories. It has been adopted as the empirical lens by which to study a variety of theoretical questions, including *institutional theory*, *agency theory*, *resource-based view*, *social network theory*, *social capital*, and *commitment theory*. Moreover, several theoretical constructs have been identified as central to the study of VC investments, such as *trust*, *distance*, *knowledge*, *social status*, *brokerage*, *uncertainty*, and *experience*.

Given the diversity of theoretical enquiries provoked in VC research, we encourage students who are interested in this general theme to read a few key articles either using VC as a context to investigate a broader theoretical question or focusing on the empirical context itself. Particular research question could be developed together with the thesis coach during the first two thesis meetings.

Nevertheless, this project entails the following requirements:

1. Quantitative analysis (use of statistical software R/Stata or the willing to learn it).
2. Collection of secondary data (e.g. Eikon Private Equity and Venture Capital databases, Crunchbase, and etc).

Relevant Literature:

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- Zhelyazkov, P. I., & Gulati, R. (2016). After the break-up: The relational and reputational consequences of withdrawals from venture capital syndicates. *Academy of Management Journal*, 59(1), 277-301.